

VISITOR VISA Who needs a visitor visa

Most travellers need a visitor visa

Most travellers need a visitor visa to travel to Canada. You may also need one if you're transiting through a Canadian airport on your way to your final destination.

A visitor visa (also called a temporary resident visa) is an official document that we put in your passport. It shows that you meet the requirements needed to travel to Canada.

A visa officer has discretion to issue you a single-entry visa or multiple entry visa, and decide how long it will be valid for. Generally, a visitor visa may be valid for up to a maximum of 10 years, or until the expiry of either your passport or biometrics, whichever comes first.

Electronic travel authorization (eTA):

About the process

The eTA application process

Applying for an [eTA](#) is a simple online process. You should apply for an eTA before you book your flight.

1. Get your passport and credit or debit card ready, and read the application help document, which is available in several languages.
2. Use the online form to apply.
3. Pay CAN\$7 for your eTA right after you complete the form.
4. Get an email about your eTA application.
 - Most applications are approved within minutes, but some can take longer.
 - You may need to submit additional documents before your application can be approved.

If this happens to you, an email will be sent with instructions within 72 hours.

An eTA doesn't let you work or study in Canada

An eTA allows you to travel to Canada by air, but **doesn't let you work or study**. Most people need a work permit to work in Canada or a study permit to study at designated learning institutions (DLIs) in Canada. If we approve your work or study permit, we'll automatically issue you an eTA.

NOTE: Citizens of Qatar are now eligible to apply for an eTA

How long you can stay

Most visitors can stay for up to 6 months in Canada.

At the port of entry, the border services officer may allow you to stay for less or more than 6 months. If that's the case, they'll put the date you need to leave by in your passport. They might also give you a document, called a visitor record, which will show the date you need to leave by.

If you do not get a stamp in your passport, you can stay for 6 months from the day you entered Canada or until the expiry of your biometrics or your passport expires, whichever comes first. Super visa holders who enter Canada after June 22, 2023 can stay for 5 years. If you need a stamp, you can ask a border services officer for one. If you arrive at an airport that uses primary inspection kiosks, you may ask the border services officer for a stamp after you finish at the kiosk.

Make sure you need a visitor visa before you apply

You may need a visitor visa **or** an Electronic Travel Authorization. The entry document you need depends on:

- the type of travel document you plan to travel with
- the country that issued your travel document
- your nationality

- how you'll travel to Canada for this trip
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Eligibility Requirements

Who can get a visa

You must meet some basic requirements to get a visitor visa.

You must:

- have a valid travel document, like a passport
- be in good health
- have no criminal or immigration-related convictions
- convince an immigration officer that you have ties—such as a job, home, financial assets or family—that will take you back to your home country
- convince an immigration officer that you will leave Canada at the end of your visit
- have enough money for your stay. The amount of money you will need depends on how long you will stay and if you will stay in a hotel, or with friends or relatives.
- You may also need a medical exam and letter of invitation from someone who lives in Canada.

Some people are not allowed to enter Canada

Some people are inadmissible to Canada, which means they are not allowed to enter the country. You can be inadmissible for several reasons, including being involved in:

- criminal activity
- human rights violations
- organized crime

You can also be inadmissible for security, health or financial reasons. Find out more about inadmissibility.

Minor children travelling to Canada

Make sure you know what to do if your minor children (children under the age of 18) will be travelling with you, with someone else, or alone.

How to apply

Venezuelan passport holders

You may need to complete extra steps when you fill out your application.

1. Prepare documents and apply

The reason you're traveling to Canada determines the way you apply and the documents you need to submit with your visa application.

Gather these documents to submit with your visa application and bring when you travel.

2. About the documents listed

- Not all documents listed below are required—some are optional.
- This is not an exhaustive list of acceptable proof to support your visa application.
- Only submit the recommended documents that prove you're eligible for a visa.
- Even if you submit all the documents listed, there is no guarantee that we'll approve your application.

- We may request more information from you in addition to what is listed here.

Tourist and Business visitor documents required

a. Identity document

Documents we accept:

- passports (regular, official or diplomatic) **from most countries (see exceptions below)**
- alien's passport for stateless persons
- US Permit to Re-Enter (Form I-327)
- US Refugee Travel Document (Form I-571)
- other refugee travel documents for non-citizens

Documents we don't accept:

- any passport issued by Somalia
- non-machine-readable passports issued by the Czech Republic
- temporary passports issued by the Republic of South Africa
- provisional passports issued by Venezuela

b. Details to include

A clear, colour copy of your valid passport or travel document that you'll use to travel to Canada

If you have a passport, you must provide a copy of

- the page that shows your birth date and country of origin
- any pages with stamps, visas or markings

If you have a travel document, it must be issued by a government and include your

- name
- date of birth
- document number
- citizenship or residency status
- photo
- expiry date (if applicable)

Submit this document with your visa application.

Minor children (if applicable)

Documents needed depend on whether a child under 18 years of age will travel with only 1 parent, with a relative or friend or alone.

Details to include

You may need to show

- a letter that authorizes the minor child to travel to Canada
- other documents, such as adoption papers or a custody decree, depending on if the minor child travels alone or not

Consult Minor children travelling to Canada.

1. Submit these with your visa application.
2. Show the border services officer when you arrive in Canada.

c. Travel history

If you've travelled to Canada or to other countries, this can show that you've been able to get a visa in the past.

Proof of this includes copies of previous visas in your passport.

Details to include

Include a clear copy of 1 or more of the following:

- your previous passports and/or visas (used within the last 10 years to travel outside your country)
- entry and exit stamps
- study and/or work permits that indicate your duration outside of your country
- expired or valid visas

d. Itinerary

Documents that show how long you plan to stay and what you'll do in Canada

Details to include

Include copies of any of the following:

- flight details
- proof of accommodation
- registration for an event

e. Bank account statement

This can help us understand if you have enough money to support yourself during your stay in Canada.

Details to include

Bank name and contact

This allows us to contact your bank or financial institution with questions.

Proof it is your account

Your name and address on the statement show that the account is yours.

Account details

At least 6 months of account details, including balances, helps us understand your financial situation.

f. Employer information for business visitor

A letter from your employer can confirm that you have a stable job and will return to it. It can also show that your employer supports your visit to Canada.

Details to include

The letter should be printed on your employer's official letterhead.

The letter should include the following:

- date, no earlier than 3 months before you apply
- confirmation that you have a job with the employer
- your full name and date of birth
- date you started the job

- brief description of your job
- current salary
- contact information of your manager
- phone number
- email address
- employer information
- company name
- address
- street
- city
- state or province
- country
- signature of employer, Your manager or human resources contact should print their name and sign the

letter. **g. Letter of invitation for business visitor.**

A letter from a business or company in Canada

It can confirm that your purpose for visiting Canada is valid.

Details to include

A copy of the letter from the business or company inviting you to Canada. The letter must be written to you from the business or company.

Consult the details to include in the letter.

NOTE: Submit all the documents with your visa application. After

you apply

Your fingerprints and photo (biometrics)

Book your biometrics collection appointment as soon as you can to avoid processing delays.

Processing your visitor visa application

We'll check your application to make sure you have all the documents you need.

If it's incomplete, your application may be refused.

We may also ask you to

- go to an interview with our officials in your country
- send more information
- get a medical exam
- get a police certificate

We'll tell you what to do if you need to do any of these.

We process most applications in a few weeks or less. Processing times depend on the visa office and if you need to do any extra steps.

Check your application status

The way to check your application status depends on how you applied. Find out how to check your application status.

If we approve your application

If you applied online

You'll get **2 letters in your IRCC account**:

- a letter with instructions to submit your passport
- our decision letter

This approval doesn't mean you can travel to Canada. You need to wait until we put the visa in the passport you submit to us.

If you applied on paper

When your application is approved, any original documents, including your passport with the visa inside, will be returned to you.

If we refuse your application

If you applied online

You'll get our decision in your IRCC account. This will explain why we refused your application.

If you applied on paper

An explanation of why your application was refused will be sent to you, along with any original documents, including your passport.

Prepare for your arrival

Documents you need before you travel to Canada

In some situations, you'll need to bring documents with you when you travel to Canada.

Situations where you may need extra documents on arrival

If either of the following situations applies to you or someone you'll travel with, have the documents indicated in hand.

You have a child under the age of 18 (a minor child)

In Canada, a child under the age of 18 is considered a minor.

You may need to show

- a letter that authorizes the minor child to travel to Canada, and
- other documents, such as adoption papers or a custody decree, depending on if the minor child travels alone or not

Find out more about minor children travelling to Canada

You were invited to come to Canada

If you got a letter from a person or company that invited you to Canada, bring that letter with you. A border services officer may ask to see it.

Your arrival in Canada

A valid visa and travel document don't guarantee that you can enter Canada.

We determine if you meet all entry requirements

When you arrive, we'll check your identity to make sure that you're the same person who was approved to travel to Canada.

- **If you enter Canada at one of 4 major Canadian airports**
 - Your fingerprints will be checked automatically at a primary inspection kiosk.
 - The system will check your identity against the information collected when your application was submitted.
- **If you enter Canada at a land port of entry**
 - Your fingerprints may be checked if we refer you to a secondary inspection, where a border services officer will use a fingerprint verification device to check your fingerprints.

When you enter Canada

If you pass the identity check, health assessment, and meet the entry requirements, the border services officer may stamp your passport or let you know how long you can stay in Canada. You're normally allowed to stay in Canada for up to 6 months.

In some cases, the officer may limit or extend your time in Canada, depending on the purpose of your visit. Ask questions if you're not sure about something.

You won't be allowed into Canada if you give false or incomplete information. The officer must be convinced that

- you're eligible for entry into Canada
- you'll leave Canada at the end of your approved length of stay